

Quality Assurance Reference Guide

Standards, Documentation, and Continuous Improvement

WHAT QUALITY ASSURANCE MEANS AT AJFC

Quality Assurance is not just about passing audits. It is about building systems that consistently deliver on the promises AJFC makes to the community. QA touches every role, every record, and every service interaction.

THE THREE PILLARS OF QA

COMPLIANCE	CONSISTENCY	IMPROVEMENT
<i>Following required standards and regulations</i>	<i>Delivering the same quality regardless of who is on shift</i>	<i>Using feedback and data to continuously get better</i>

DOCUMENTATION ESSENTIALS

- Complete records at the time of service, not after the fact.
- Be specific: who, what, when, and what was the outcome.
- Never alter a record after it has been submitted. Use amendment procedures.
- Treat every file as if it could be reviewed by a funder tomorrow.

THE PDCA IMPROVEMENT CYCLE

PLAN	Identify the problem or opportunity and design a solution.
DO	Implement the solution on a small scale first.
CHECK	Evaluate the results. Did it work?
ACT	If it worked, standardize it. If not, adjust and try again.

YOUR QA RESPONSIBILITIES

- Know the compliance standards for your specific program area.
- Flag errors or gaps as soon as you spot them, do not wait for a review cycle.
- Participate constructively in internal audits and peer reviews.
- Ask questions when a process is unclear rather than guessing.

"Quality is never an accident. It is always the result of intelligent effort."

— John Ruskin